

working with in OPML format. Clicking on any link in the feed's news item opens the page in the application itself.

It carries a lot of navigational aids that make managing news items easier. News items can be grouped on their source, date or on their tag. A tag can be applied by you by right-clicking on the news item. Messages can be made hidden based on their read status. It regularly checks for newer items in the feed, and this information is displayed near the system tray as a pop up.

A Smartfeed is a feed that can be created from the other feeds that are being handled by FR. Criteria for including news items from other feeds into the smart feed can be specified. So accessing the smartfeed will list those feeds that match the criteria. To create a new Smartfeed use the Net button. Smartfeeds use a blue icon in contrast to the orange icon of normal feeds. The Smartfeed appears alongside other feeds in the left panel, and can be named.

Under the Tools menu, the Preload Feeds link opens a list of preloaded feeds which are categorised into different groups, from which you can easily select and subscribe. Feeds that have additional content attached can be handled with the Enclosure browser which allows downloading the attached content. The Options link allows configuring FR.

Overall, FR comes across as a capable feed reader, but it somehow lacks intuitiveness, which can be discouraging.

7.2.3 Other Feed readers

Thunderbird

This jack of all trades also includes a feed reader. After the local or remote feed address is provided, the familiar three pane window is displayed. The news headings are displayed on the top, and select-



Thunderbird's feed reader interface